

SECRET

MEMORANDUM: FOR SECRETARY MORGENTHAU'S INFORMATION ONLY

We report to you herewith a story which is so shocking and so tragic that it is difficult to believe.

On the basis of the cold facts contained for the most part in State Department documents (which we have finally managed to obtain despite the strenuous opposition of certain State Department officials, including what appears to have been a deliberate falsification of one of the documents), the following points stand out so clearly and so sharply that, despite our efforts to explain them away, we have been unable to do so:

(1) In October 1942 Sumner Welles as Acting Secretary of State instructed our Minister in Switzerland to obtain full information confirming the plans of the German Government for the complete extermination of the Jews in Europe.

(2) Notwithstanding the specific instructions of the Acting Secretary of State, Atherton and Dunn not only failed to facilitate the obtaining of this information but in their official capacity went so far as to stop the obtaining of information concerning the murder of the Jewish population of Europe.

(3) Breckinridge Long is responsible for the attempt to conceal this whole situation from this Department.

To put it bluntly, Mr. Secretary, it appears that certain responsible officials of this Government were so fearful that this Government might act to save the Jews of Europe if the gruesome facts relating to Hitler's plans to exterminate them became known, that they not only attempted to suppress the facts but, in addition, they used the powers of their official position to secretly countermand the instructions of the Acting Secretary of State ordering such